

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Subcontinent as connected ecological regions

HIMALAYA / NORTH-WEST PASSES

Kabul-Indus corridors | snowmelt rivers | frontier exchange

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INDUS BASIN ---- THAR/ARAVALLI ---- GANGA PLAIN ---- BRAHMAPUTRA VALLEY
floodplains copper/route alluvium/rice rain/river routes

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VINDHYAS / CENTRAL BELT

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DECCAN PLATEAU ---- EASTERN/WESTERN GHATS ---- COASTS AND DELTAS
black soils/metals passes and rain shadow ports, rice, maritime links

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/9: River systems as opportunity and hazard

INDUS/CHAGGAR-HAKRA

GANGA-YAMUNA

PENINSULAR RIVERS

winter + monsoon flows	deep alluvium, doabs	plateau-cut, often seasonal
Harappan settlement	farming/state corridor	irrigation, deltas and ports
channel migration risk	flood/waterlogging risk	variable monsoon dependence

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Rivers enable water, silt and transport; institutions determine capture and resilience.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Monsoon-ecology-production loop

SEASONAL MONSOON

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rain timing  river flow vegetation pasture  sailing winds
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crop choice  flood risk forest work herding  maritime season
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Surplus and settlement depend on storage, water control, labour and risk-sharing.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Resource geography and specialised regions

RESOURCE -> REPRESENTATIVE ZONES -> HISTORICAL CAPACITY

copper	-> Aravalli/Khetri	-> tools, exchange, craft centres
iron	-> central/eastern India	-> tools and weapons; use remains contextual
stone	-> Rohri/Deccan/Vindhya	-> lithics, architecture and sculpture
timber	-> forest belts	-> fuel, construction, boats, state frontier
salt	-> arid/coastal sources	-> essential exchange networks
elephant	-> eastern forests	-> military resource, not sole cause of empire

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Why settlements occupy particular landscapes

SITE SELECTION

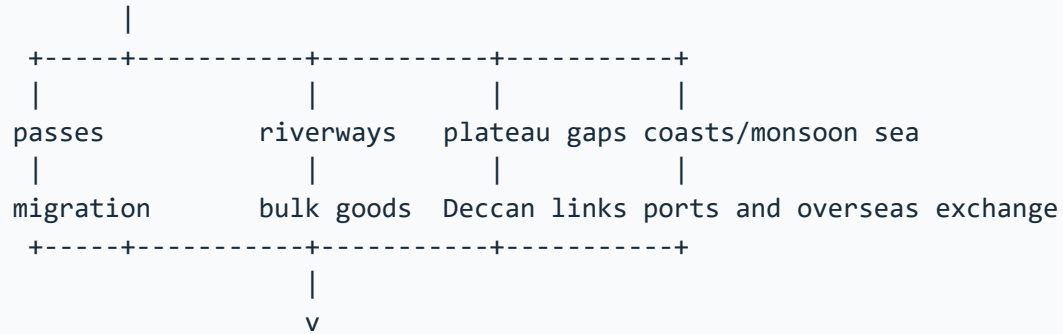
- |-- water reliability
- |-- cultivable soil and grazing
- |-- defensibility and flood safety
- |-- raw-material access
- |-- route, ford or port position
- |-- disease and drainage constraints
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+-> SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY: camp -> village -> craft centre -> town -> capital

Geography sets costs and options; social organisation converts them into settlement.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Routes: movement creates historical corridors

LAND AND WATER ROUTES



Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Changing historical landscapes

PALAEOLITHIC → NEOLITHIC/CHALCOLITHIC → HARAPPAN → VEDIC → EARLY HISTORIC

mobile use	village mosaics	urban-rural	NW to Ganga	towns/states/routes
stone/water	crops/herds	basin links	forest edge	Magadha/Deccan/coasts
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No all-India stage occurs simultaneously: regional sequences overlap and diverge.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Determinism versus possibilism

~~DETERMINIST CLAIM: fertile soil, iron, river or monsoon automatically produces a state.~~

EVIDENCE AGAINST: similar environments yield different timings and institutions.

POSSIBILIST CORRECTION: ecology offers constraints, opportunities and recurring risks.

MEDIATORS: technology + labour + property + exchange + political organisation + culture

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VERDICT: explain why an opportunity was mobilised, by whom, and with what limits.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: Historical-geography answer architecture

15 MARKS: text map -> opportunities + constraints -> institutional mediators -> named case

15 MARKS: text map -> opportunities + constraints -> institutional mediators -> variation

20 MARKS: physical frame -> river/monsoon/resource systems -> chronological cases

-> routes and uneven regions -> determinism debate -> qualified synthesis

MAP RULE: label only places used in the argument; link each label to one consequence.

CLOSE: geography conditions history, but institutions select and transform options.